



**VNU UNIVERSITY OF
ECONOMICS & BUSINESS**

Faculty of International Business & Economics

FINAL ASSIGNMENT

SUBJECT:

**DATA ANALYSIS IN ECONOMICS AND BUSINESS
(FDE3021-E)**

**Analysis of Business Performance and Artistic
Trends of Pixar Animation Films from 1995 - 2024**

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A.INTRODUCTION

I.Rationale for choosing the topic

Nowadays the animation industry is incredibly competitive. Various of studios have to walk a fine line between making great art and staying profitable. Pixar in fact is a giant in the field, but even they aren't immune to changing audience tastes. The question is that how do they keep making hits while ensuring every dollar spent actually brings value back?

When we looking at the numbers, it turns out that a massive budget doesn't guarantee a massive return. Pixar always delivers quality through high critic scores don't always equal high box office sales. And some movies get great reviews but don't make much money, while some huge-budget projects barely break even. Success seems to depend more on the movie's "DNA". The genre, the director, and the timing would rather than just how much cash was thrown at it. And even factors like release seasons and age ratings play a bigger role than expected.

This means that analyzing data is not just a "nice to have" but it's crucial. It allows the studio to see exactly what and how it works, which directors earn the most value and why certain films underperform. It connects the dots between the artistic quality and the actual profit.

That is why this project uses dashboards like “Beyond the Screen” and “Pixar DNA.” With the goal to dig into the key metrics such as Revenue, ROI, and Awards to truly understand Pixar's history. This isn't just about looking back. It’s about using that information to make smarter, sustainable decisions for the future.

II. Research purpose

The study aims to achieve the following key objectives:

+ Providing an overall evaluation of cinematic success through key performance indicators such as Box Office Revenue, Production Budget, ROI, Critical Scores (Metacritic/Rotten Tomatoes, IMBD), and Academy Award Wins which across multiple

dimensions, including Genre, Director, Film Rating, and Run Time.

- + Identifying the key stones of success and failure in film production throughout the studio's history from 1995 to 2024.
- + Proposing data-driven insights that optimize thoughtful investments, balance artistic quality with commercial viability, and also enhance strategic decision-making for future productions.

II. Research areas

Data Scope: The analysis utilizes the 'Pixar Films' dataset, curated by software engineer Eric Leung and hosted by Maven Analytics. The data scope contains a comprehensive record of all 28 Pixar feature films released from the studio's debut with Toy Story from 1995 through Inside Out 2 in 2024. The dataset is structured across 22 distinct fields and providing specific three key areas:

- + Financial Records: Production budgets and domestic/international box-office earnings.
- + Production Metadata: Credits for core creative teams which including directors, screenwriters, producers, and composers.
- + Critical Reception: Aggregate critic ratings, Oscar nominations, and Academy Award wins.

Content Scope:

- + Analysis of key metrics that measuring cinematic and commercial success.
- + Comparative evaluation of performance across genres, directors, film ratings (G/PG) and historical time periods.
- + Assessment of ROI and the correlation between production factors (Budget, Runtime) and final outcomes (Box Office, Awards).

Tools Used: Microsoft Power BI.

Subjects of Analysis: Feature films produced by Pixar Animation Studios and examining both their financial efficiency in the global market and their artistic reception by critics and the Academy.

B. ANALYSIS

I. Data processing

1. Loading data into Power Query and performing preprocessing

- Loading data sets into Power BI

Queries [6]

academy
box_office
genres
pixar_films
pixar_people
public_response

Table.TransformColumnTypes(#"Promoted Headers",{{"film", type text}, {"rotten_tomatoes_score",

	film	rotten_tomatoes_score	rotten_tomatoes_counts	metacritic_score	metacritic_counts
1	Toy Story	100	96	95	
2	A Bug's Life	92	91	78	
3	Toy Story 2	100	172	88	
4	Monsters, Inc.	96	199	79	
5	Finding Nemo	99	270	90	
6	The Incredibles	97	250	90	
7	Cars	75	204	73	
8	Ratatouille	96	253	96	
9	WALL-E	95	261	95	
10	Up	98	297	88	
11	Toy Story 3	98	313	92	
12	Cars 2	40	220	57	
13	Brave	79	256	69	
14	Monsters University	80	203	65	
15	Inside Out	98	387	94	
16	The Good Dinosaur	75	220	66	
17	Finding Dory	94	339	77	
18	Cars 3	69	234	59	
19	Coco	97	357	81	
20	Incredibles 2	93	390	80	
21	Toy Story 4	97	459	84	
22	Onward	88	350	64	
23	Soul	95	360	83	

- Checking columns data types of each table, click “Use first row as Headers”

Queries [6] ←

✕ ✓ fx = Table.TransformColumnTypes(Source,{{"column1", type text}, {"column2", type text}, {"column3", type ▼

	AFC Column1	AFC Column2	AFC Column3
1	film	award_type	status
2	Toy Story	Animated Feature	Award not yet introduced
3	Toy Story	Original Screenplay	Nominated
4	Toy Story	Adapted Screenplay	Ineligible
5	Toy Story	Original Score	Nominated
6	Toy Story	Original Song	Nominated
7	Toy Story	Other	Won Special Achievement
8	A Bug's Life	Animated Feature	Award not yet introduced
9	A Bug's Life	Adapted Screenplay	Ineligible
10	A Bug's Life	Original Score	Nominated
11	Toy Story 2	Animated Feature	Award not yet introduced
12	Toy Story 2	Original Screenplay	Ineligible
13	Toy Story 2	Original Song	Nominated
14	Monsters, Inc.	Animated Feature	Nominated
15	Monsters, Inc.	Adapted Screenplay	Ineligible
16	Monsters, Inc.	Original Score	Nominated
17	Monsters, Inc.	Original Song	Won
18	Monsters, Inc.	Sound Editing	Nominated
19	Finding Nemo	Animated Feature	Won
20	Finding Nemo	Original Screenplay	Nominated
21	Finding Nemo	Adapted Screenplay	Ineligible
22	Finding Nemo	Original Score	Nominated
23	Finding Nemo	Sound Editing	Nominated

- Then the table should be:

Queries [6] ✕ ✓ f_x = Table.TransformColumnTypes(#"Promoted Headers",{{"film", type text}, {"award_type", type text},

	film	award_type	status
1	Toy Story	Animated Feature	Award not yet introduced
2	Toy Story	Original Screenplay	Nominated
3	Toy Story	Adapted Screenplay	Ineligible
4	Toy Story	Original Score	Nominated
5	Toy Story	Original Song	Nominated
6	Toy Story	Other	Won Special Achievement
7	A Bug's Life	Animated Feature	Award not yet introduced
8	A Bug's Life	Adapted Screenplay	Ineligible
9	A Bug's Life	Original Score	Nominated
10	Toy Story 2	Animated Feature	Award not yet introduced
11	Toy Story 2	Original Screenplay	Ineligible
12	Toy Story 2	Original Song	Nominated
13	Monsters, Inc.	Animated Feature	Nominated
14	Monsters, Inc.	Adapted Screenplay	Ineligible
15	Monsters, Inc.	Original Score	Nominated
16	Monsters, Inc.	Original Song	Won
17	Monsters, Inc.	Sound Editing	Nominated
18	Finding Nemo	Animated Feature	Won
19	Finding Nemo	Original Screenplay	Nominated
20	Finding Nemo	Adapted Screenplay	Ineligible
21	Finding Nemo	Original Score	Nominated
22	Finding Nemo	Sound Editing	Nominated
23	The Incredibles	Animated Feature	Won

2. Rename tables in to dim and fact tables based on their data types

- “pixar_films” as “dim_films”
- “pixar_people” as “dim_crew_roles”
- “genres” as “dim_genres”
- “box_office” as “fact_office”
- “public_response” as “fact_public_response”
- “academy” as “dim_academy”

dim_films
dim_crew_roles
dim_genres
fact_office
fact_public_response
dim_academy

3. Adjusting the model view

- For relationships between “dim_crew_roles” and “dim_films”, “dim_genres” and “dim_films”, “fact_office” and “dim_films”, “fact_public response” and “dim_films”. Edit relationships between those with cross-filter direction into both.

Edit relationship ✕

Select tables and columns that are related.

From table
dim_crew_roles

film	name	role_type
Toy Story	Pete Docter	Storywriter
Toy Story	John Lasseter	Storywriter
Toy Story	Joe Ranft	Storywriter

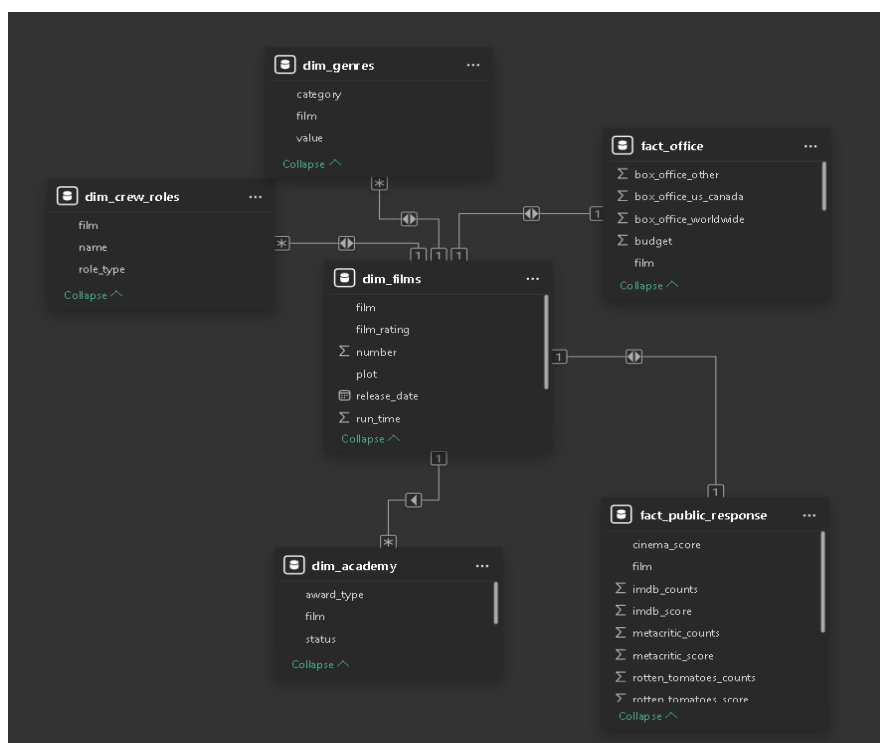
To table
dim_films

film	film_rating	number	plot	release_date	run_time
Toy Story	G	1	A cowboy dol...	Wednesday, ...	81
A Bug's Life	G	2	A misfit ant, l...	Wednesday, ...	95
Toy Story 2	G	3	When Woody...	Wednesday, ...	92

Cardinality
Many to one (*:1)

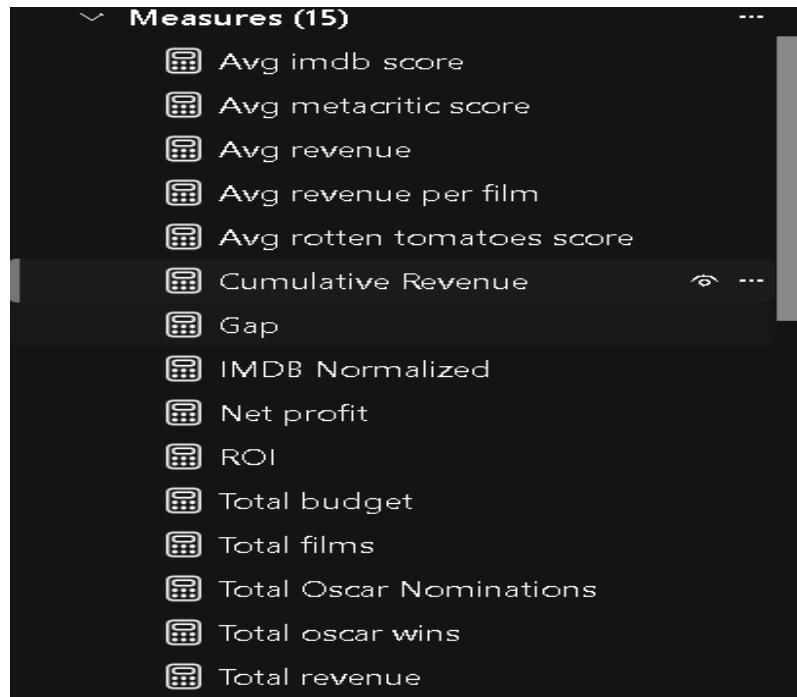
Cross-filter direction
Both

- Then the model view should be:



4. Creating new measures

- In Power BI, creating new measures in New Measure



1. **Total Oscar Nominations** = CALCULATE
(COUNTROWS(dim_academy),dim_academy[status]="nominated")
2. **Total oscar wins** =
CALCULATE(COUNTROWS(dim_academy),dim_academy[status]="Won")
3. **Avg revenue per film** = divide([Total revenue], [Total films], 0)
4. **Total films** = countrows(dim_films)
5. **Avg revenue** = AVERAGE(fact_office[box_office_worldwide])
6. **Cumulative Revenue** = CALCULATE(
SUM(fact_office[box_office_worldwide]), FILTER(ALL(dim_films),
dim_films[release_date] <= MAX(dim_films[release_date])))
7. **Net profit** = [Total revenue] - [Total budget]
8. **ROI** = DIVIDE([Net profit], [Total budget], 0)
9. **Total budget** = sum(fact_office[budget])

10. **Total revenue** = Sum(fact_office[box_office_worldwide])
11. **Avg imdb score** = AVERAGE(fact_public_response[imdb_score])
12. **Avg metacritic score** = Average(fact_public_response[metacritic_score])
13. **Avg rotten tomatoes score** =
AVERAGE(fact_public_response[rotten_tomatoes_score])
14. **Gap** = [IMDB Normalized] -
AVERAGE(fact_public_response[rotten_tomatoes_score])
15. **IMDB Normalized** = AVERAGE(fact_public_response[imdb_score]) * 10

II. Dashboard visualization and analysis

1. Beyond the Screen: Financial Insights

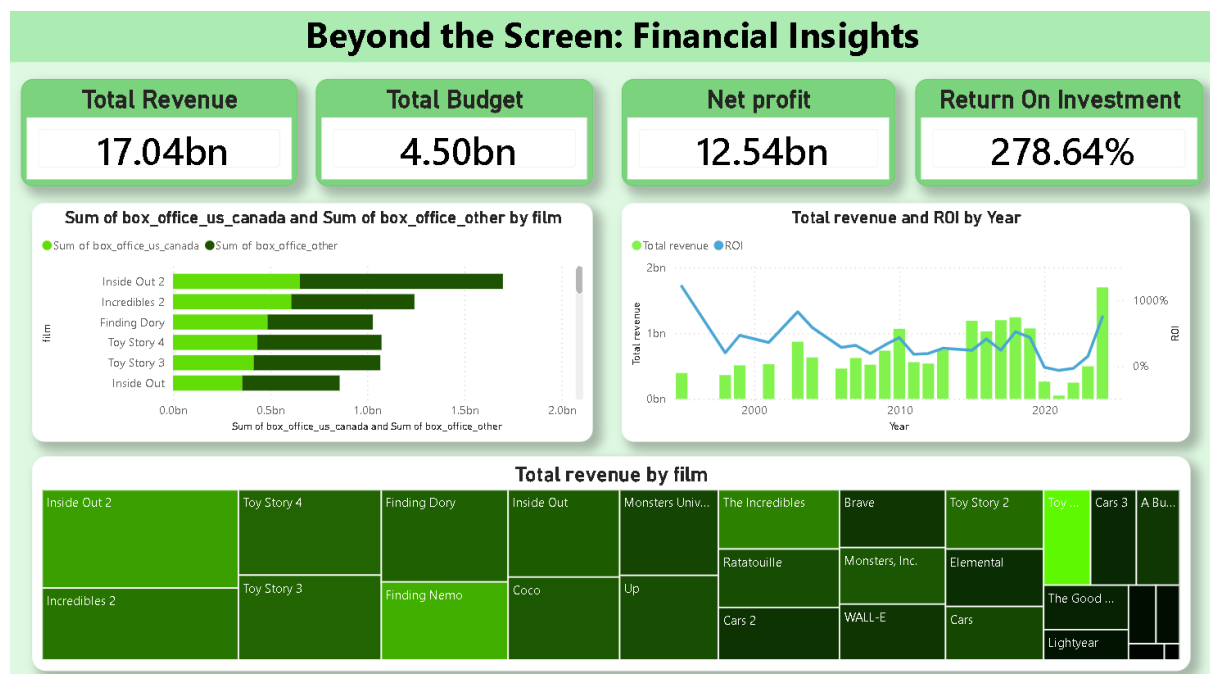


Figure 1.1: Financial dashboard

- **Executive overview :**

The 'Beyond the Screen: Financial Insights' dashboard acts as a financial health check for the Pixar and Disney catalog. Moving beyond simple ticket counts to identify what truly drives profit, analyzing the connection between budget, global reach, and

ROI. As this is a 'hit-driven' industry, success relies on a few massive blockbusters rather than consistent wins across the board. This can be seen clearly in 2024, when the standout performance of Inside Out 2 effectively offset the instability of previous years

- **Aggregate financial efficiency:**



Figure 1.2: Pixar Financial Performance Overview

The big picture shows that the portfolio is operating very efficiently. Spending a Total Budget of **\$4.50 billion** to generate **\$17.04 billion** in Total Revenue which leaves with a massive Net Profit of **\$12.54 billion**. The most crucial data here is the Return on Investment (ROI) of **278.64%**. To simplify it, for every **\$1.00** invested in production, the studio earned nearly **\$2.79** in pure profit. This results in a profit margin of approximately **73.6%** ($\$12.54\text{bn} / \17.04bn) which clearly shows that despite rising production costs, the studio's "blockbuster strategy" is still working well enough to provide a safety net against occasional underperformers.

- **Geographic & Franchise Strategy**

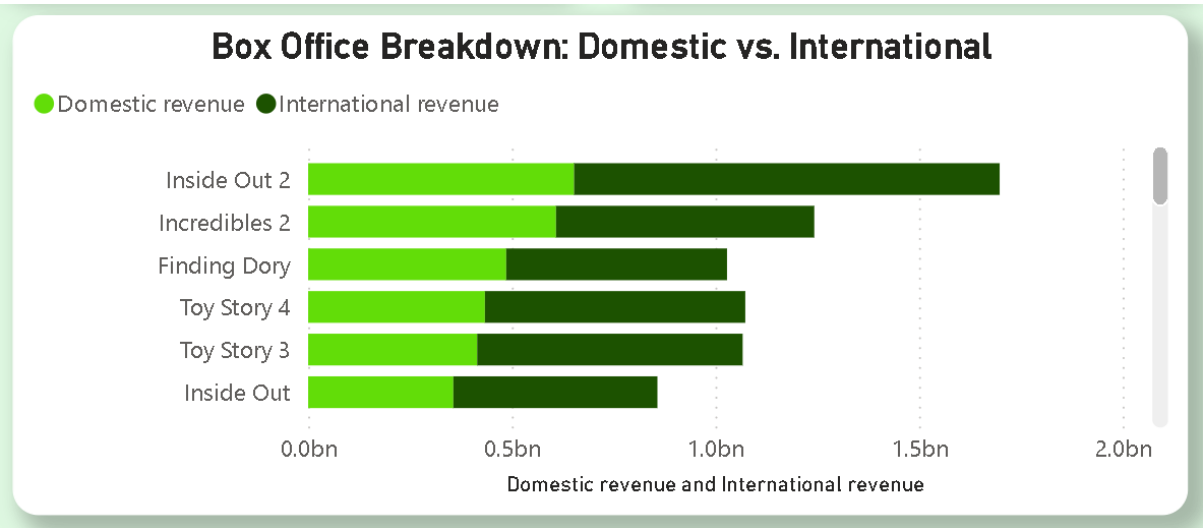


Figure 1.3: Domestic & International Gross by Film

The revenue chart highlights two main trends: the dominance of sequels and the importance of global audiences. The **top earners** are all familiar names such as Inside Out 2, Incredibles 2, Finding Dory, and Toy Story 4. These films heavily outsell original titles, proving that leaning on established franchises is a safe, high-reward strategy to guarantee ticket sales. However, the real story is where the money comes from, as a prime example Inside Out 2 earned **\$652.9 million** in the **US and Canada**, compared to a massive **\$1.04 billion internationally**. While **overseas markets** accounting for roughly **61%** of the total gross, it is clear these films are global products.

- **Historical Trajectory & Volatility**

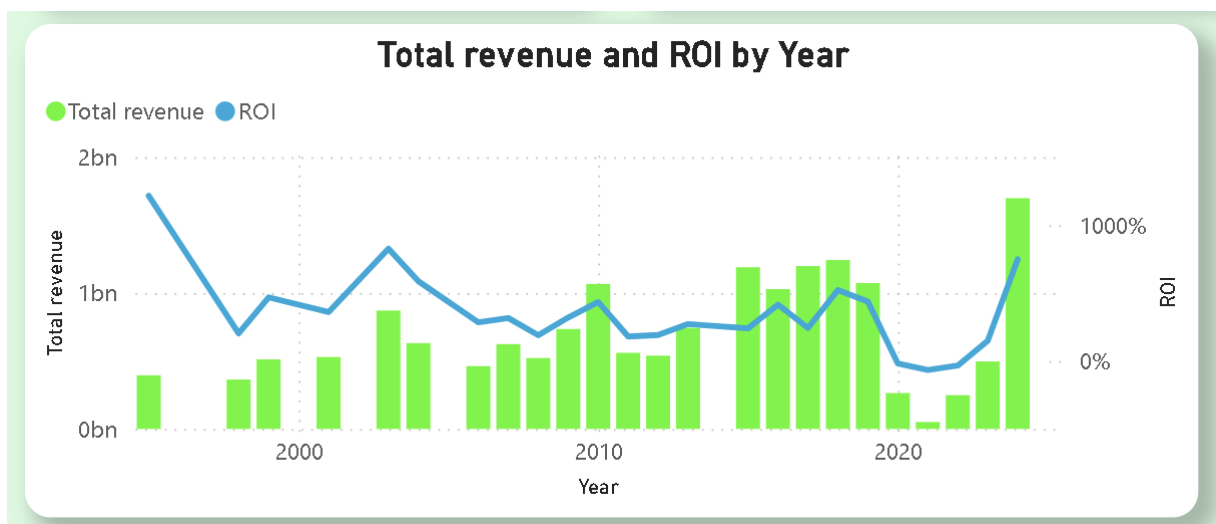


Figure 1.4: Total revenue and ROI by year

Looking at the timeline of Revenue and ROI, we notice that success is rarely a straight line. While there was a steady growth **from 2010 to 2019**, the years following the pandemic brought significant instability. The contrast between recent years is massive with **2022**, Pixar took a hit and ending with an ROI of **-33.80%** while revenue dipping to **\$248 million** as theaters struggled to recover. However, **2024** marked an incredible comeback by Inside Out 2, the numbers skyrocketed to a record-breaking ROI of **749.02%** and **\$1.69 billion** in revenue. This huge recovery means the studio can bounce back from losses with just one big hit, confirming that betting on big franchises is an absolute solid strategy.

- Portfolio Concentration (The "Pareto" Effect)

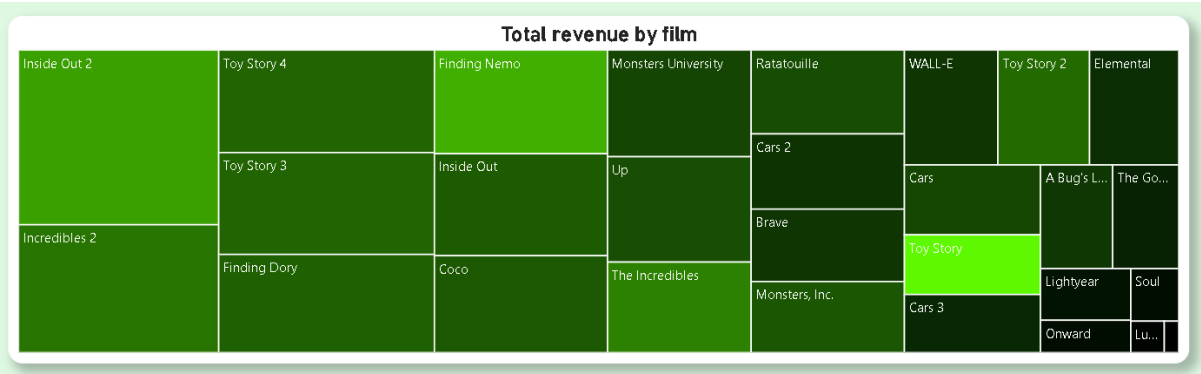


Figure 1.5: Total revenue by film

The Tree Map clearly shows us where the real value lies. It highlights the "Big 6" blockbusters that led by Inside Out 2 and Incredibles 2. Dominating the chart while films like The Good Dinosaur and Lightyear appear as much smaller sections. This is the "Pareto Principle" in action that a small minority of films are generating the vast majority of the revenue. The gap between the hits and the misses is massive, with Inside Out 2 generated approximately \$1.70 billion which is nearly 7.5 times the \$226 million revenue of Lightyear. This is a key insight for risk management., it implies that "mid-tier" films don't contribute to the studio's overall financial health as much as the giants. Consequently, the studio’s stability actually depends heavily on the success of these flagship sequels, rather than simply churning out a high volume of movies.

- Conclusion & Recommendation

The "Financial Insights" dashboard shows the studio is thriving because of a "Global Franchise" strategy. With an overall ROI of 278%, the numbers look great but depend heavily on international blockbusters. The massive bounce back in 2024 shows that even after a slump like 2022, audiences still crave to established franchises. For long-term success, the studio needs to keep focusing on these core brands and more careful with the budgets for originals or unproven movies.

Based on the data, here are three strategic steps:

1. Adopt a "Tiered" Budget Strategy: The data shows a huge gap between established hits and new titles. Pixar should split their investment accordingly and give the "**Cash Cow**" franchises like **Toy Story** or **Inside Out** the big budgets because they guarantee returns. For original ideas, set a lower and safer budget. This prevents financial losses on risky titles as **Lightyear**, while still allowing room to invent the next big thing.

2. Go "Global-First": International sales are the real engine here with **Inside Out 2** making ~61% of its money overseas is proof. Meaning future marketing shouldn't just focus on the US, it needs to prioritize the **global audience**. This shows better localization and timed releases to capture the maximum revenue from international markets that are clearly our biggest earners.

3. Smooth Out the Volatility: The sharp "**V-shaped**" recovery in 2024 exposes a weakness that we rely too much on one big hit to save the year. To fix this rollercoaster trend, we need to control the costs strictly on **non-franchise** films with the goal is to ensuring Pixar stays profitable every year, even when they don't have a record-breaking blockbuster in theaters.

2. Pixar: Hall of Fame

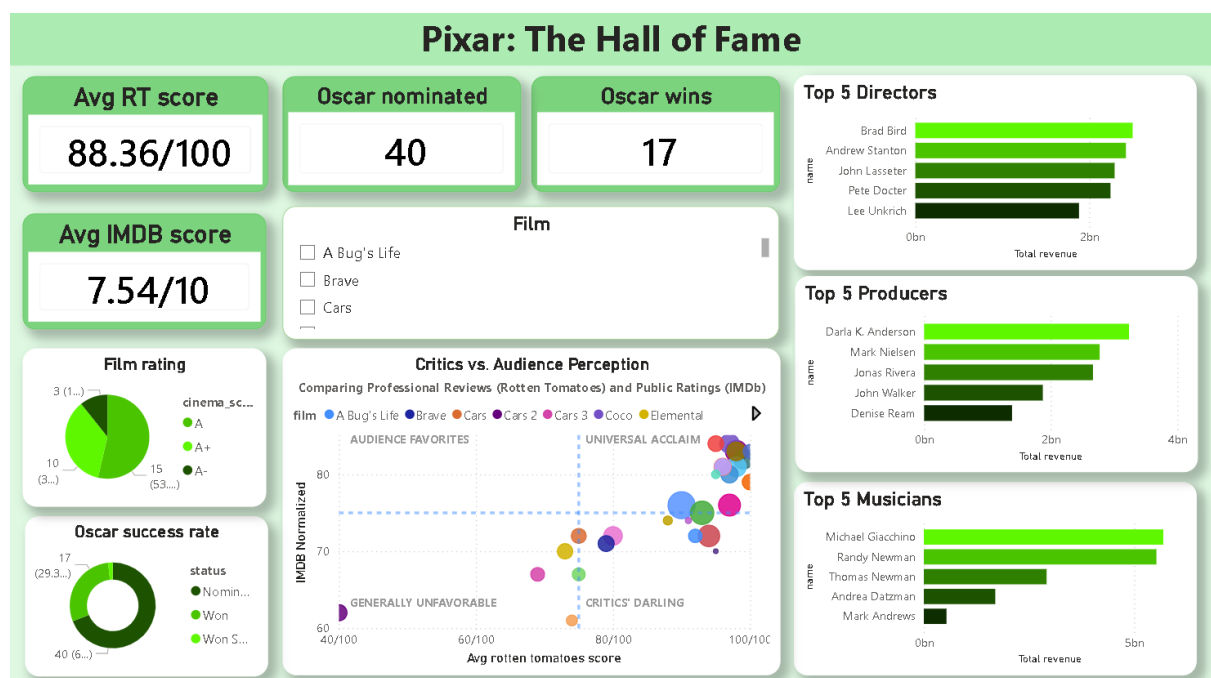


Figure 2.1: Product quality and brand equity dashboard

- **Executive overview**

The "Pixar: Hall of Fame" dashboard shifts the focus from money to reputation. While the previous dashboard looked at financial volume, this one measures pure quality. Combining critic scores, audience ratings, and Oscar wins show us the exact why this studio is legendary. The data reveals that Pixar operates at a level far above the industry standard by Rotten Tomatoes scores to Academy Award win rates, the metrics are consistently high. Confirming that Pixar's brand value isn't just marketing hype, Pixar is built on a solid and proven history of artistic excellence.

- **Review aggregates**

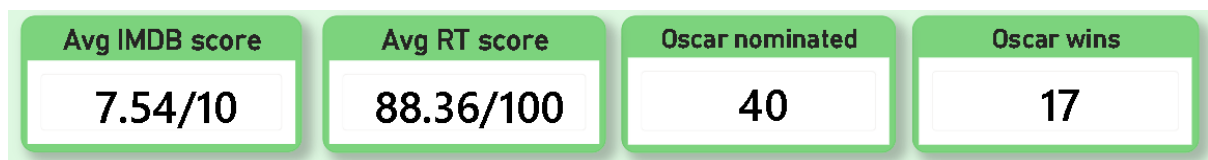


Figure 2.2: Scores and Oscar overview

The KPIs show that Pixar operates on a level rarely seen in animation. On one hand, the average Rotten Tomatoes score of **88.36/100**, Pixar earned universal praise from critics. On the other hand, the average IMDB score of **7.54/10** is also impressive, though the slight difference suggests that critics appreciate Pixar's complex storytelling even more than general audiences do. The most telling stat is their performance at the Academy Awards, with total of **40** nominations, Pixar has secured **17** wins which resulting in a remarkable **42.5%** win rate. These figures prove that Pixar isn't just making "content" but they are consistently producing high-quality films that command respect from the entire industry.

- **Audience Approval and Award Success**

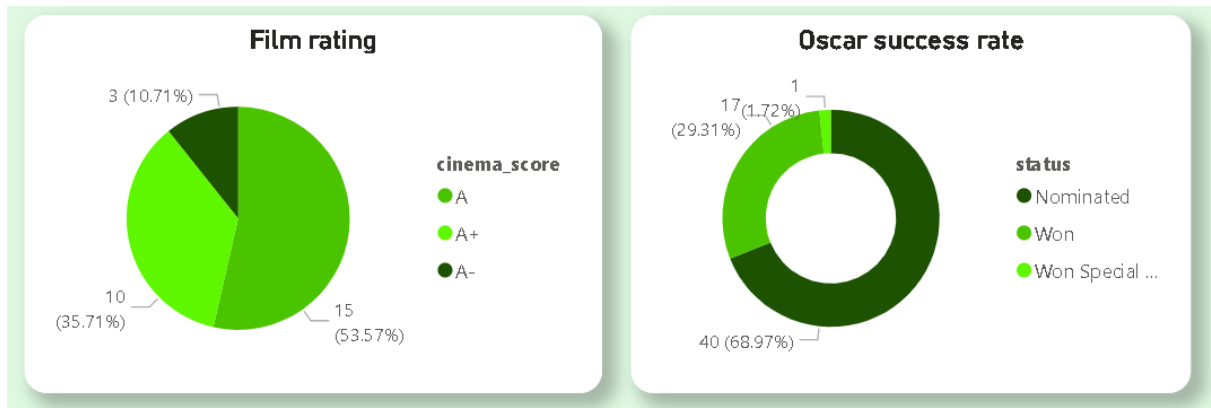


Figure 2.3: Film rating and Oscar success rate

The **Cinema Score** ratings prove that audiences trust Pixar implicitly, with **10** films earning an "A+" and **15** securing an "A" the studio rarely misses. And even their "lowest" rated films, just 3 titles with an "A-" still outperform the industry average. This consistency of Pixar proves that viewers don't just watch these movies, they leave the theater emotionally satisfied almost every time. The **Oscar record** is equally telling, beyond the **17 wins** and **40 nominations**, the inclusion of a **Special Achievement Award** highlights Pixar's role as a pioneer. Meaning Pixar aren't just winning awards, they are often pushing the boundaries of animation technology itself. This track record puts them in a league of their own, where their biggest competition is often their own past success.

- **Critics vs. Audience Ratings**

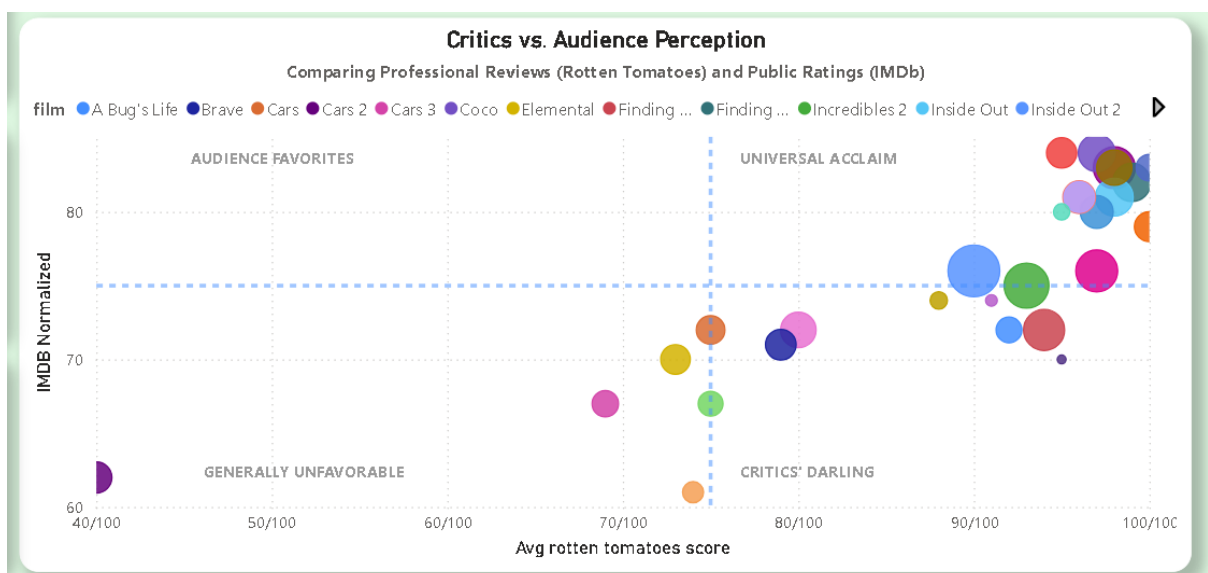


Figure 2.4: Critics vs Audience perception

The scatter plot shows a strong connection between what professional critics think and how audiences feel. It is easily to see that most of Pixar's movies land squarely in the "**Universal Acclaim**" zone, consistently staying above **80%** on Rotten Tomatoes and **70** on IMDB. This reveals Pixar has mastered the rare ability to satisfy strict artistic standards while still being entertaining for the average viewer. Moreover, Cars 2, which sits low with a **40/100** RT score and **62** on IMDB. However, this actually highlights the brand's **resilience** that one creative miss didn't ruin their reputation. While some films might lean slightly more toward critics or fans, Pixar's true "sweet spot" is clearly right in the middle, where smart storytelling meets mass appeal.

- **Revenue Performance of Creative Leadership**

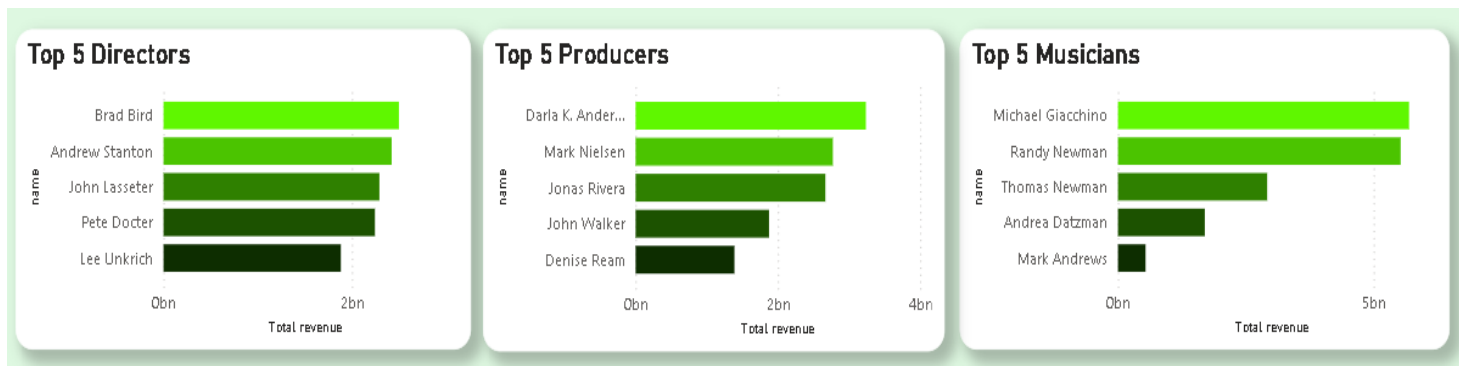


Figure 2.5: Revenue by top 5 directors, producers and musicians

Breaking down the finances by creative talent shows that Pixar's success is a group effort, not a one-man show. Among directors, the numbers are tight with Brad Bird leads with **\$2.5 billion** in total revenue, followed closely by Andrew Stanton (**\$2.42 billion**) and John Lasseter (**\$2.29 billion**). The fact that the top four all exceed **\$2.2 billion** proves the studio relies on a solid team of leaders rather than a single superstar. Moreover, the impact of producers and musicians is even bigger, with producer Darla K. Anderson is linked to over **\$3.23 billion** in revenue, showing how vital production management is. However, the composers are the real heavyweights, Michael Giacchino and Randy Newman have both crossed the **\$5.5 billion** mark more than double the top

directors. This means that the music and "sound" of Pixar are a massive part of what keeps audiences coming back.

- **Conclusion & Recommendations**

The data confirms that Pixar's success isn't luck but it's a system. With an average critic score of **88.36/100** and consistent "**A**" ratings from audiences, they have mastered the balance between high art and mass entertainment, this reputation allows the studio to dominate the market even when taking creative risks. And the numbers also show that Pixar is a team effort, not a one-man show, while directors drive revenue, the "sound" of Pixar is just as powerful. Musicians like Michael Giacchino and Randy Newman have influenced over **\$11 billion** in revenue combined. Having **40** Oscar nominations, Pixar has set a standard that forces the entire animation industry to keep up.

Based on these insights, here are three strategic recommendations:

1. Treat Music as Core IP: The data uncovers a hidden asset: the music. Top composers are linked to over **\$5.5 billion** in revenue each double that of the top directors. So that Pixar need to lock these talents down with long-term plans. Their music provides the emotional continuity that keeps the brand strong across generations.

2. Protect the "A" Grade: Pixar's biggest advantage is trust. With **89%** of the portfolio scoring an "**A**" or "**A+**" CinemaScore, audiences expect excellence. As Pixar produce more for streaming, they cannot lower the bar. Dropping to an "**A-**" or below risks damaging the brand, because viewers look to Pixar for elite experiences, not just content.

3. Aim for the "Sweet Spot": We should focus on movies that satisfy both critics and fans, for example: a movie like Cars 2 made money despite bad reviews, it hurts the brand's prestige in the long run. So future projects should aim for "**Universal Acclaim**" avoiding films that just chase box office numbers without the storytelling quality that defines the Pixar label.

3. Pixar DNA: Deep dive and Trends

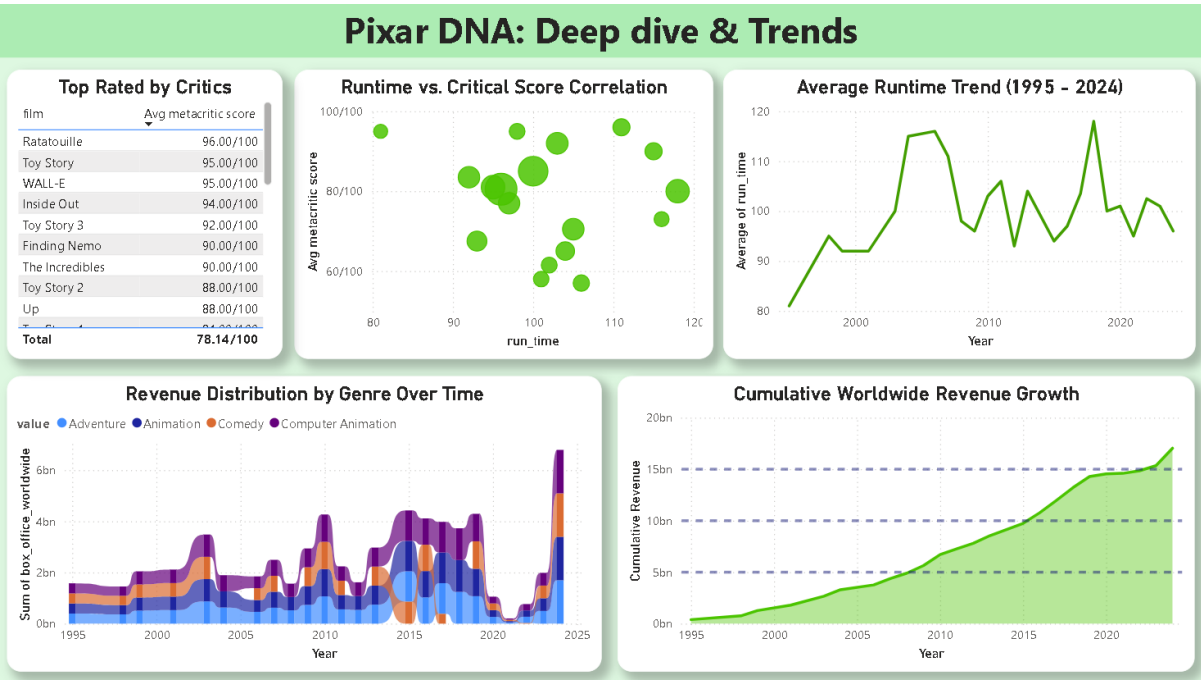


Figure 3.1: Pixar’s film fomula dashboard

- **Executive overview**

The "Pixar DNA" dashboard tracks the studio's journey from 1995 to 2024. It combines review scores with financial data to show exactly how Pixar balances artistic quality with massive commercial success. The main takeaway is consistency. With an average Metacritic score of **78.14/100**, the studio maintains high standards while closing in on **\$20 billion** in total global revenue. Besides, the data also shows how they have evolved, expanding into genres like Adventure and Comedy to stay relevant. This dashboard proves that the "Pixar Formula" works: a disciplined focus on great storytelling is exactly what turned the studio into a sustainable economic powerhouse.

- **Statistical Analysis of Critical Dominance**

Top Rated by Critics	
film	Avg metacritic score
Ratatouille	96.00/100
Toy Story	95.00/100
WALL-E	95.00/100
Inside Out	94.00/100
Toy Story 3	92.00/100
Finding Nemo	90.00/100
The Incredibles	90.00/100
Toy Story 2	88.00/100
Up	88.00/100
Toy Story 4	84.00/100
Soul	83.00/100
Total	78.14/100

Figure 3.2: Top rated by critics

The "Top Rated" data proves that Pixar operates in a league of its own. With a weighted average score of **78.14/100**, their "average" film is often better than the industry's best. And leading the pack is Ratatouille (**96/100**), closely followed by the original Toy Story and WALL-E, both at **95/100**, this top tier is reinforced by the emotionally complex Inside Out (**94/100**) and Toy Story 3 (**92/100**), showing that their biggest creative risks often yield the highest rewards. What is truly impressive is the depth of quality, with Finding Nemo and The Incredibles both hold a **90/100**, while Up and Toy Story 2 follow with 88/100. While newer entries like Toy Story 4 (**84/100**), Soul (**83/100**), and Coco (**81/100**) stay firmly in "universal acclaim" territory. This shows a "high-floor" strategy: Pixar simply doesn't make bad movies.

- **The Pacing Paradox: Optimizing Narrative Density**

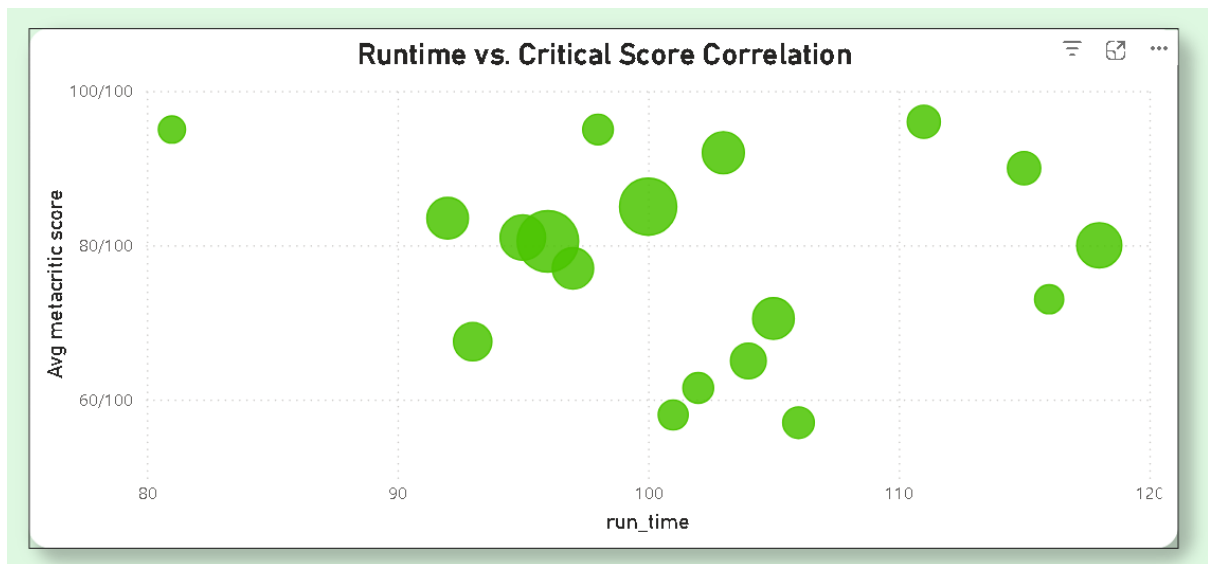


Figure 3.3: Runtime vs Critical score correlation

The data shows that a movie's length doesn't guarantee its quality. Instead of a straight line, we see two clear "sweet spots" at opposite ends:

- + The Short Game: Films at the **81-minute** mark scored a massive **95/100**.
- + The Epic: Films at **111** minutes achieved the highest score of **96/100**.

This proves the studio wins with both tight with fast-paced stories and longer and sweeping sagas. The middle ground is where things get shaky, the **100-to-106 minute** range sees a sharp drop in quality, hitting lows of **59/100** (at **100 mins**) and **57/100** (at **106 mins**). Suggesting films in this "muddled middle" often suffer from pacing issues. And even the longest film at **118 minutes** held a decent **80/100**, but it couldn't match the peaks of the others. Ultimately, there is no "perfect" runtime, the highest scores go to films that are exactly as long as the story needs to be, while the mid-length films tend to suffer the most from feeling bloated.

- **Chronological Analysis**

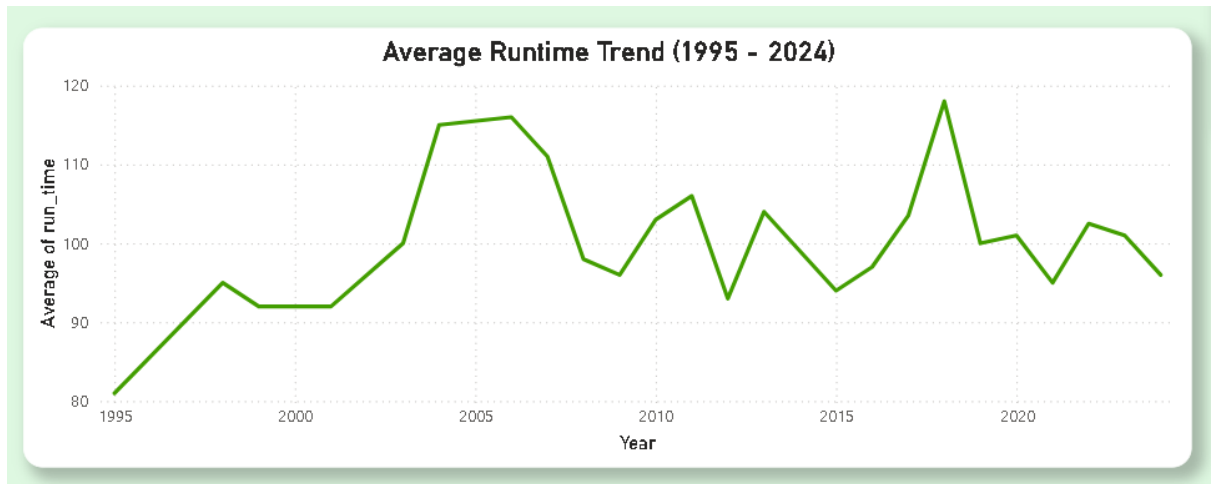


Figure 3.4: Average runtime trend(1995-2024)

Looking at the timeline from 1995 to 2024, Pixar's movie lengths don't just go up in a straight line. Instead, they expand and contract like a heartbeat. It started lean in 1995 with just **81 minutes** which mostly due to early technical limits. As the studio grew confident, runtimes exploded and hitting **115 minutes** in 2004 and **116 minutes** in 2006, meaning that they could hold an audience as long as a live-action blockbuster. From there, it fluctuated as we saw a dip to **93 minutes** in 2012, followed by a climb to the all-time peak of **118 minutes** in 2018. Since 2020, however, films are getting shorter again with runtimes stabilized at **100.5 minutes** in 2020 and dropped to **96 minutes** in 2024, which shows Pixar is adapting to modern viewing habits (perhaps due to streaming), finding a new "sweet spot" for storytelling just under the **100-minute** mark.

- **A Longitudinal Revenue Analysis**

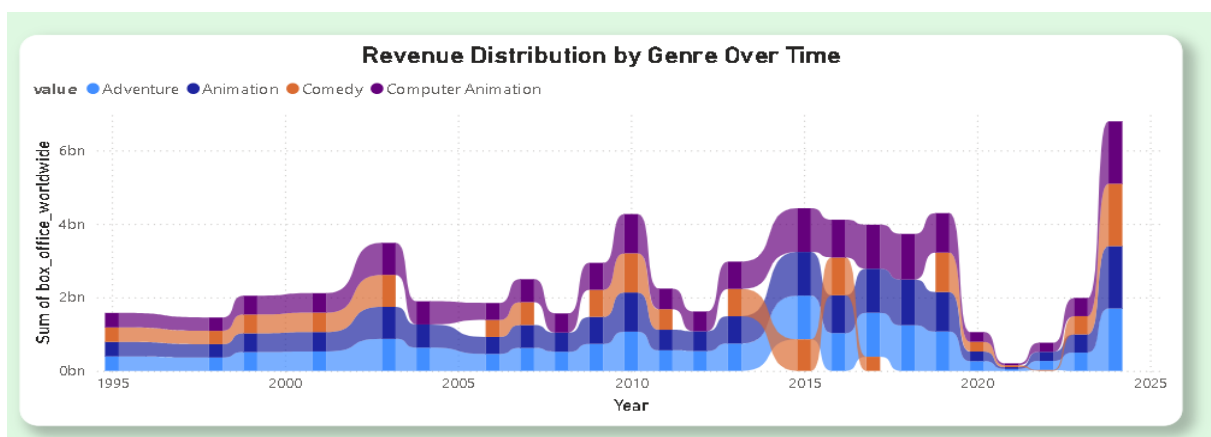


Figure 3.5: Revenue distribution by genre over time

The revenue data charts Pixar's journey from a new player to a billion-dollar giant, driven mostly by mixing Adventure and Comedy. It all started in 1995 with **\$361,958,896**, establishing the baseline, the growth was steady until 2003, when revenue spiked to **\$867,893,978**, proving that "Adventure" films could drive massive sales. The real turning point hit in 2010, when the studio joined the "Billion Dollar Club" with a staggering **\$1,063,171,911**, which signaled a shift toward big franchises. The peak of this era ran from 2018 to 2019, with back-to-back hits earning **\$1,242,805,359** and **\$1,073,394,593**, which showed that the Adventure-Comedy formula was the most profitable strategy in animation. Then the pandemic hit hard, revenue plummeted to just **\$141,950,171** in 2020 and bottomed out in 2021. However, the most important takeaway is the massive comeback in 2024, revenue skyrocketed to an all-time high of **\$1,687,267,984**, beating even the best years of the 2010s. Proving despite the streaming shift, the demand for high-stakes theatrical animation is stronger than ever.

- **A Trajectory of Brand Equity**

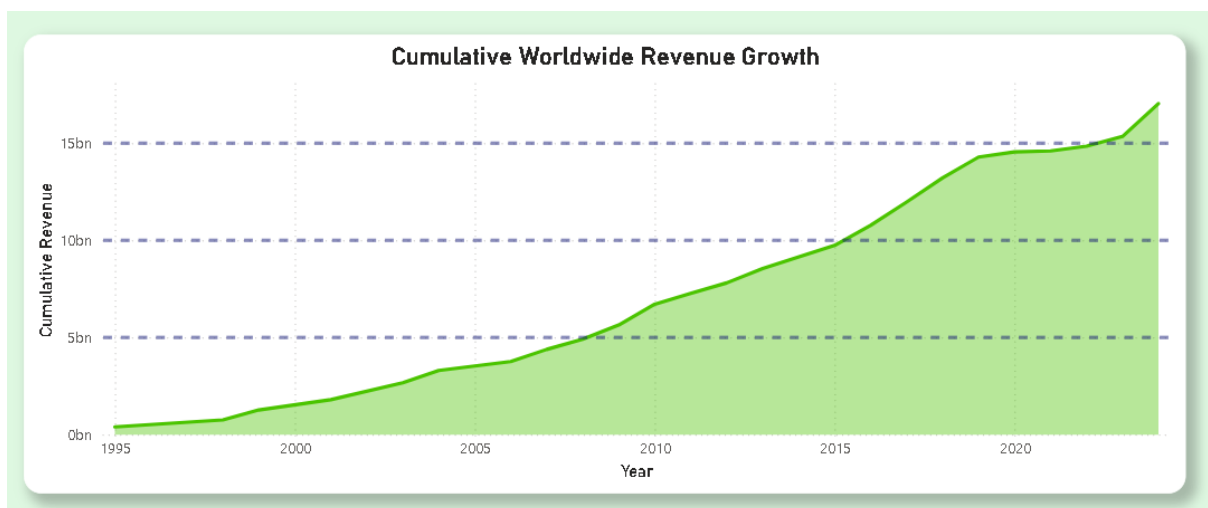


Figure 3.6: Cumulative worldwide revenue growth

This chart tracks Pixar's journey from a startup to a \$16.8 billion giant and it started in 1995 with **\$361,958,896**. In just 4 years, by 1999, the studio had already tripled its value, crossing the billion-dollar mark to hit **\$1,210,687,354**. A major turning point

came in 2010, when total revenue jumped from **\$5.5 billion** to **\$6.6 billion** in a single year. The pace kept accelerating, and by 2015, the studio smashed through the **\$10 billion** ceiling, reaching **\$10,473,040,140**. Growth flatlined between 2020 (**\$14.6 billion**) and 2023 (**\$15.1 billion**), during this "lost era," the studio added less than \$500 million over nearly four years. However, 2024 brought an explosive recovery, the total shot up to **\$16,807,137,392**, adding nearly **\$1.7 billion** in just one period. This proves that the brand wasn't declining and it was simply waiting for the right blockbuster to unlock its value again.

- **Conclusion & Recommendations**

Looking at the data as a whole, it is clear that Pixar's dominance isn't luck but it is a system. The link between their high critical average (**78.14/100**) and their massive cumulative revenue (**\$16.8 billion**) confirms a simple economic truth: for Pixar, quality is what makes money. The studio has never stood still, they evolved from 81-minute experiments to **118-minute** epics and shifted their focus to "Adventure-Comedy" to capture wider audiences. The massive recovery in 2024 proves the brand is resilient. It shows that as long as the storytelling remains strong, the "Pixar Formula" can survive any market downturn.

To ensure future growth, the data suggests three specific strategies:

1. Double Down on "Adventure-Comedy": History shows this is the winning formula, moving from simple animation to a hybrid "Adventure-Comedy" style is what drove revenue into the multi-billions. Future projects should prioritize this mix: high-stakes adventure draws the crowds, while comedy ensures re-watchability. This combination is the strongest path to the "Billion Dollar Club."

2. Watch the "Danger Zone": There is a pacing trap regarding runtime, the data shows that films between **100** and **106 minutes** suffer from volatile critical scores. To maintain quality, Pixar should avoid this "muddled middle.", so the strategy should be binary: either keep it tight and efficient (**~90 minutes**) or commit fully to an epic scale (**~110 minutes**).

3. Prioritize the Big Screen: The numbers prove that Pixar's value depends on the theatrical experience, the streaming-heavy "Lost Era" (2020-2023) caused growth to stagnate, while the return to theaters in 2024 caused a vertical revenue spike. The market views Pixar movies as "events.", therefore, exclusive theatrical releases must be the priority, as streaming simply cannot generate the same exponential value.

C. REFERENCES

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